

Work Report

Personal Portfolio — "Empty but Live" Milestone

Client	Vinay Kumar	Date	July 28, 2026
Deliverable	index.html (single-file)	Status	Complete

Overview

Built a self-contained landing page marking the "Empty but Live" milestone for the portfolio site. The page went through two iterations: an initial dark-mode build using the Tailwind CSS CDN script for speed, then a revision that replaced the CDN dependency with hand-written CSS after a production console warning was flagged, removing the external dependency entirely.

Requirements Delivered

- Standard HTML5, fully self-contained in a single index.html file
- Dark-mode design in a Slate/Zinc palette with a subtle emerald accent
- Fully responsive layout across mobile and desktop breakpoints
- Pulsing status badge: "■ Portfolio Under Construction — Build Week Active"
- Milestone note describing what's live and what's coming next
- Footer reading "Build Week Milestone | 2026"
- No external assets, build steps, or local dependencies required

Design Approach

The page uses a terminal-style status card as its signature element — an *echo \$STATUS* line with a blinking cursor — tying the visual language to the frontend/AI-ML engineering identity rather than defaulting to a generic hero layout. Ambient emerald and slate glow shapes drift slowly in the background, echoing the green of the status badge without introducing new colors. Motion is deliberately restrained (badge pulse, cursor blink, slow ambient drift) and fully disabled under *prefers-reduced-motion*.

Revision: Production-Ready CSS

The first version loaded Tailwind via the public CDN script, which logs a console warning indicating it isn't intended for production use. Since the environment here has no network access to run the Tailwind CLI/PostCSS build, the fix was to hand-write plain CSS equivalents for the small, fixed set of utility classes the page actually uses. The visual result is identical; the CDN script and its warning are gone, and the file has zero external requests.

Recommendation for Next Phase

As the case studies, identity kit, and full project showcase are added, the hand-written CSS in this file can keep being extended manually, or a proper Tailwind build (CLI or PostCSS) can be set up at that point for a larger codebase. The CDN script is fine for quick prototypes but isn't meant to scale with a growing site.

Deliverable: index.html (self-contained, no dependencies)